here some days ago and starts for Tehran with a force of I suppose about ten thousand men of all arms tomorrow. He has already bestowed upon me the appointment of chief Interpreter and has given me his royal autograph, granting me this appointment; my firman (commission) granting me this post is not yet sealed because the large seal is not yet cut or engraved, my pay is not fixed and will not be, until I arrive at Tehran, that of the late chief Interpreter, who died of cholera in '46 was very high, about one thousand ducats a year say £450 – –. The king treats me with great kindness and I have no doubt I shall get on well. We do not expect much opposition on the road, perhaps, which God grant, none at all. But we go prepared to meet it. Even I and my servant are fully armed. I can not describe the enthusiasm of all the govt servants, I know more than one man who has sold almost every thing he had, to enable him to march with the Shah to Tehran, trusting to his good luck to come in for a share of the good things at the capital. I am much in the same position, and as I have received no pay should have been hard run if it had not been for my friend Mr Stevens our Consul, who will advance me something against the govt bonds, drawn on the revenues of the custom-house for my pay. (the old pay of two hundred ducats a year).

You are I dare say surprised that the people should come forward to serve this young king seeing that his govt during the last six months as I have often informed you has been as bad as need be, and he was by no means popular. But the people consider him as *their* king and both nobles and people are determined to put him on the throne. And they would consider it the highest disgrace if they allowed any other province to interrupt the succession by putting another on the throne. From want of money I have had the greatest difficulty in making up my camp equipment, humble as it is, but when you consider that we shall in all probability, not be in a house or perhaps not within walls until we get to Tehran, you may suppose that a man can not travel very lightly. I am in high spirits at our departure and shall give you all the news as we go along the road, as opportunities occur for sending letters.

I am very glad that you made no further application to the Foreign Office about me, the govt always look shy upon a man who bothers them, and if I had not been in debt, there is no reason (don't laugh) why I should not have been an ambassador by this time, or something like it. I have been refused employment in the British service more than once because of the position Charles has placed me in. In your letter you write "Tell me whether you are in debt on your own seperate individual account and to what amount etc." My letter of the spring of 1846 which went along with the Hadji's letter to Charles will explain this. The amount for which I am liable is about Ts 25,000 say £12,500, these debts

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